

PROJECT BASED LEARNING REPORT

On Virtual Memory Management Simulator

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ABSTRACT

This project implements a Virtual Memory Management Simulator that demonstrates different page replacement algorithms such as FIFO, LRU, and Optimal. The system simulates how an operating system manages limited RAM and decides which memory page to replace when new pages are required.

The project uses arrays, loops, and logical decision-making to simulate memory frames and track page faults. It highlights how efficient memory management improves system performance and reduces page faults. This project demonstrates the practical application of Operating System concepts in solving real-world problems related to memory allocation and optimization.

INTRODUCTION

Virtual memory is an important concept in operating systems that allows programs to use more memory than physically available in RAM. When the memory is full and a new page needs to be loaded, the system must decide which existing page to remove.

This decision is made using page replacement algorithms. In this project, we simulate three commonly used algorithms:

- FIFO (First In First Out)
- LRU (Least Recently Used)
- Optimal Page Replacement

The simulator helps understand how different algorithms behave and how they impact performance in terms of page faults.

OBJECTIVES

- To simulate virtual memory management using programming
- To implement page replacement algorithms (FIFO, LRU, Optimal)
- To understand the concept of page faults and memory frames
- To compare efficiency of different algorithms
- To demonstrate real-world working of OS memory management

SYSTEM ANALYSIS

In real systems, RAM is limited, and programs require efficient memory allocation. Without proper algorithms, memory usage becomes inefficient and increases page faults.

This system simulates memory using an array representing frames. When a page is requested:

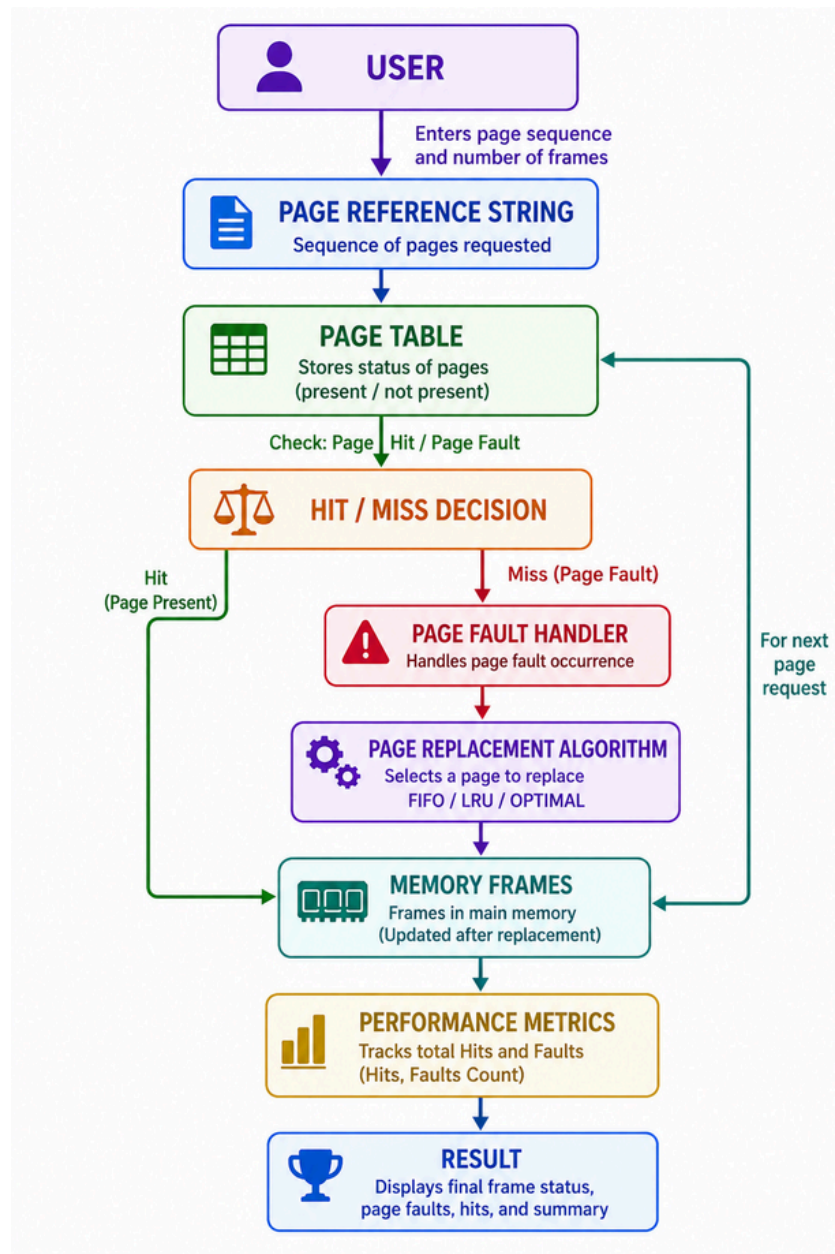
- If it is already in memory → No fault
- If not → Page fault occurs

Algorithms decide which page to remove:

- FIFO removes oldest page
- LRU removes least recently used page
- Optimal removes page not used for longest future time

This automated simulation provides accurate and fast decision-making compared to manual calculation

ER DIAGRAM AND SCHEMA DESIGN



Entities

- Pages
- Memory Frames
- Page Table
- Page Replacement Algorithm

Relationships

- Pages are loaded into frames
- Frames update memory state
- Algorithm decides page replacement

Conceptual Flow

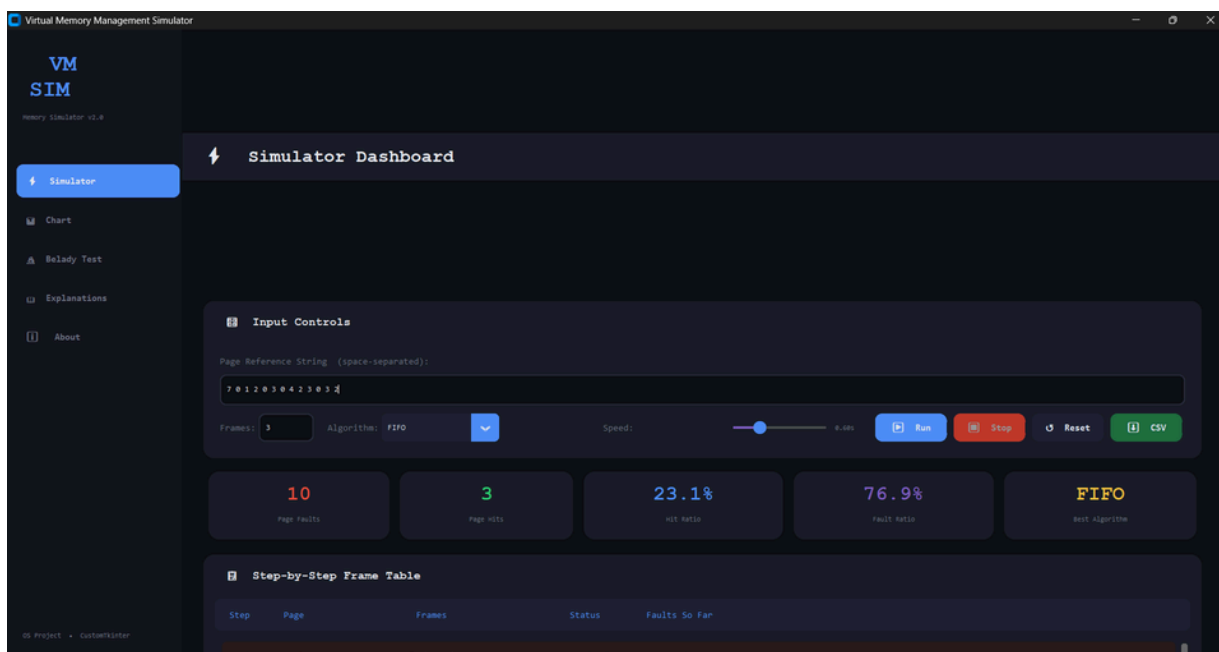
Page Request → Check Memory → Page Fault → Apply Algorithm → Replace Page → Update Memory

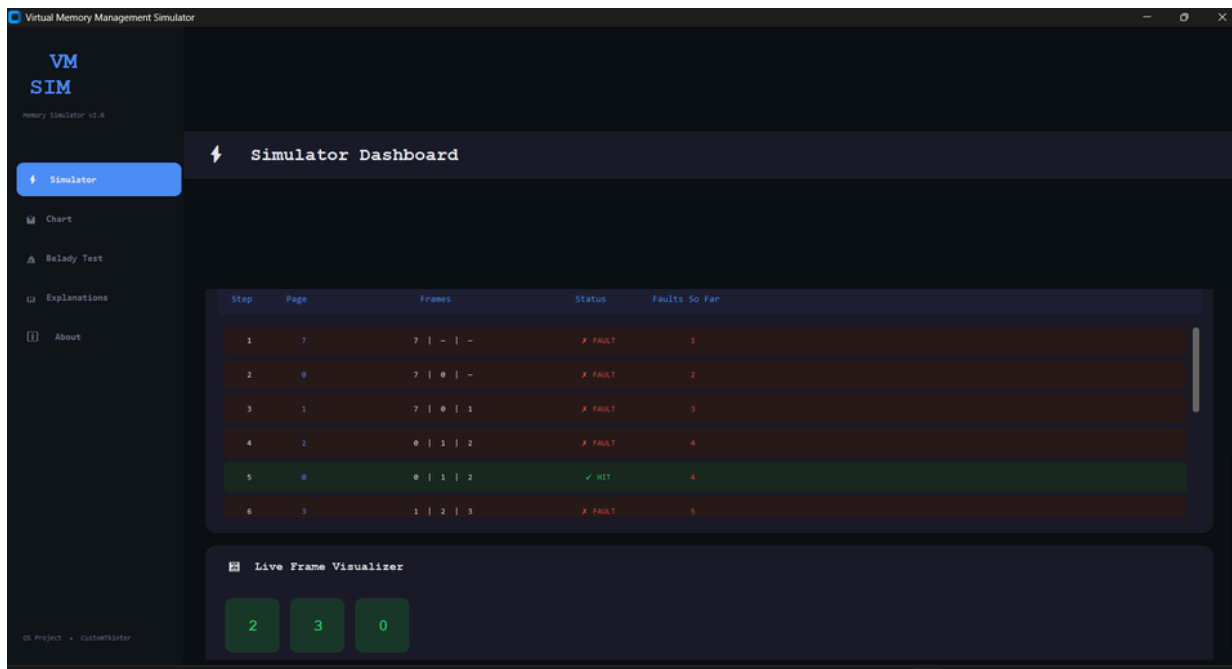
IMPLEMENTATION

- Memory frames are represented using arrays
- Page sequence is taken as input from user
- Separate functions implemented for:
 - FIFO algorithm
 - LRU algorithm
 - Optimal algorithm
- Loop traversal is used to check page presence
- Counters are used to calculate page faults
- Output displays:
 - Frame status after each step
 - Final result (page faults and hits)

OUTPUT

Stimulator Dashboard

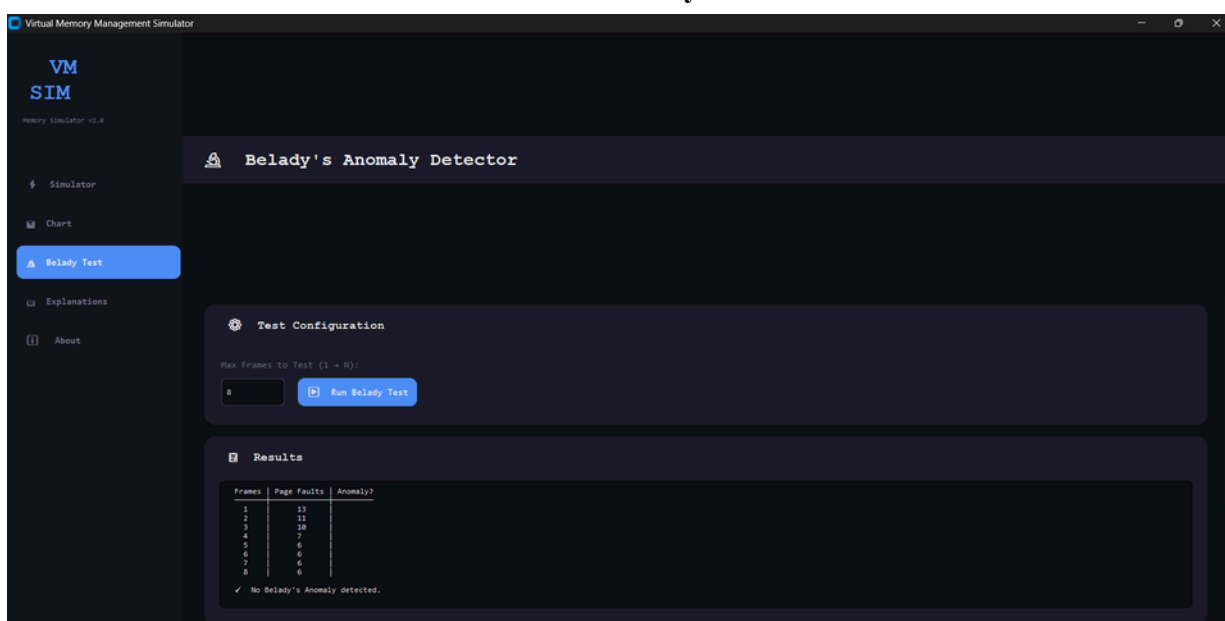


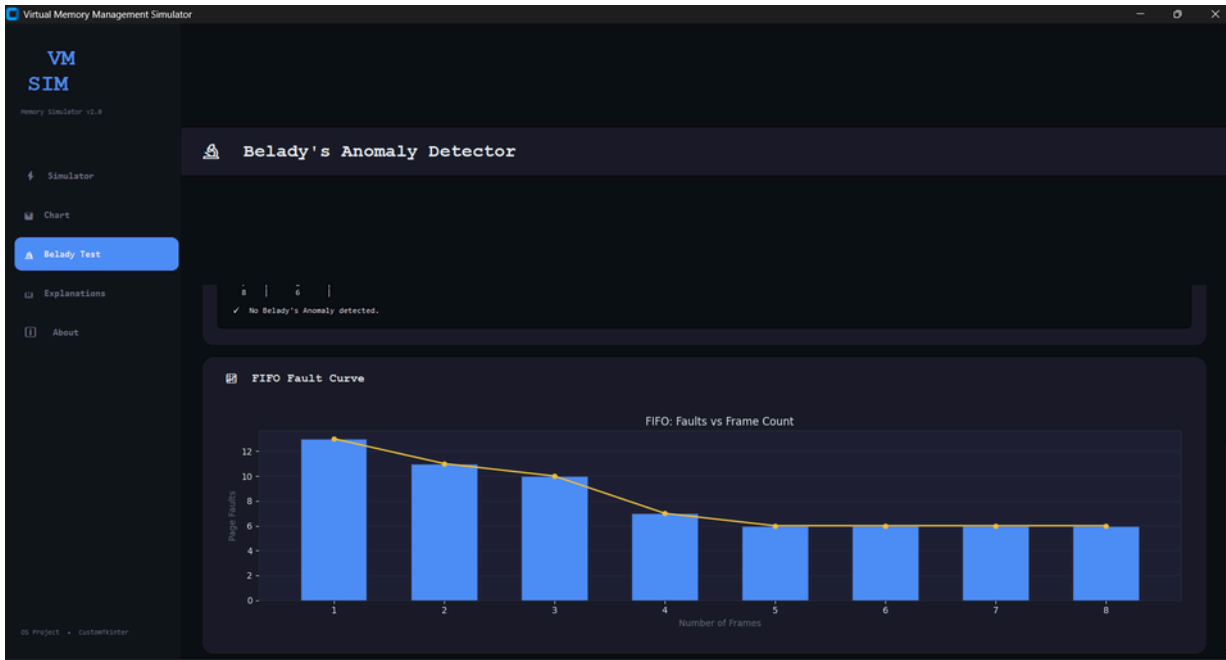


Chart



Belady Test





Explanations

Virtual Memory Management Simulator

VM SIM
Memory Simulator v1.0

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Algorithm Explanations

FIPO

First-In First-Out (FIPO)

The oldest page in memory is the first to be replaced when a new page must be loaded. The frames act as a circular queue.

- ✓ Simple to implement
- ✓ Low overhead
- ✗ Ignores page usage frequency
- ✗ Suffers from Belady's Anomaly

View Faults -> Hit -> Page -> Reference

LRU

Least Recently Used (LRU)

Replaces the page that has not been used for the longest period of time. Based on temporal locality.

- ✓ Good approximation of optimal
- ✓ No Belady's Anomaly
- ✗ Requires tracking access order
- ✗ Hardware support needed for full efficiency

OS Project - CustomKiller

Virtual Memory Management Simulator

VM SIM
Memory Simulator v1.0

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Optimal

Optimal (OPT / Belady's)

Replaces the page that will not be used for the longest future period. Requires knowledge of future references.

- ✓ Theoretically minimum page faults
- ✓ Useful as a benchmark
- ✗ Not implementable in practice
- ✗ Needs complete future reference string

View Faults -> Hit -> Page -> Reference

Compare All

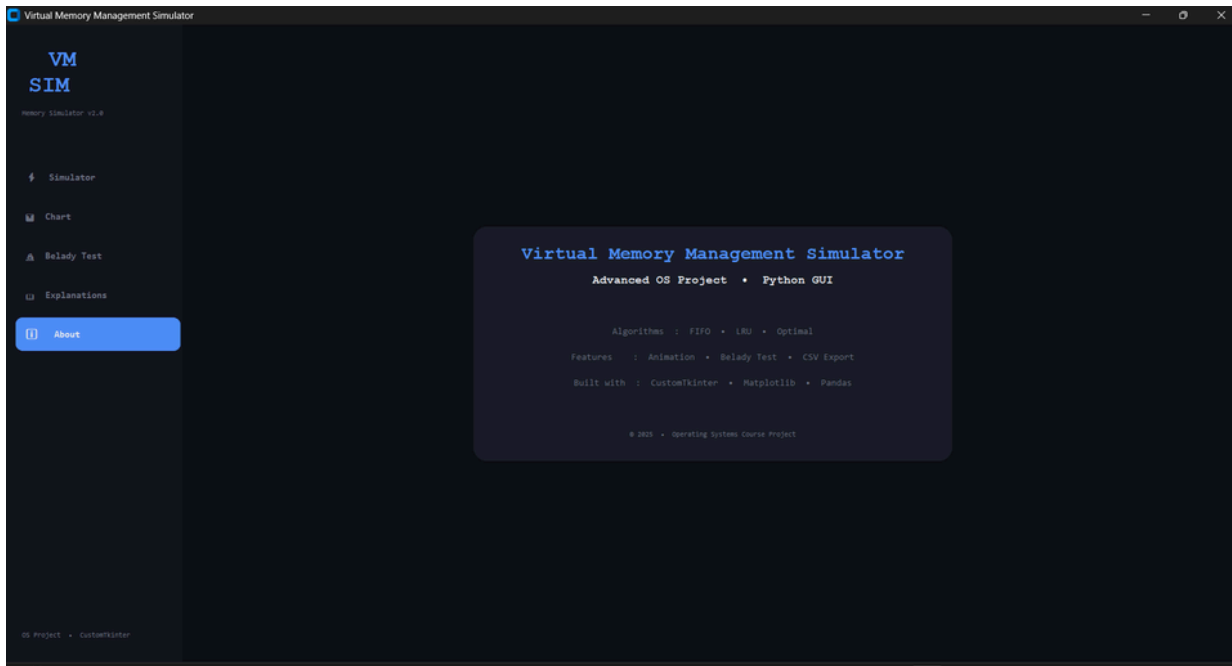
Algorithm Comparison

Runs all three algorithms on the same reference string and capacity, then displays a side-by-side fault/hit summary and an embedded bar chart so you can identify the best strategy for your workload.

General ranking (fewer faults is better):
Optimal < LRU < FIPO (in most real cases)

View the recommendation and see the simulation for each

OS Project - CustomKiller



RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The simulator successfully demonstrates how different page replacement algorithms work.

- FIFO is simple but may lead to more page faults
- LRU performs better by using past usage data
- Optimal gives best performance but is theoretical

The comparison shows how algorithm choice affects system efficiency.

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

This project demonstrates the importance of memory management in operating systems. The simulation clearly shows how page replacement algorithms help in efficient use of RAM.

Future Scope

- Add graphical user interface (GUI)
- Real-time visualization of memory frames
- Implement additional algorithms (Clock, LFU)
- Extend to multi-process memory simulation
- Integrate with real OS-level data

REFERENCES

- Operating System Concepts
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- Tutorialspoint – Operating System Tutorials
- W3Schools – Basic Programming Concepts
- Classroom notes and lecture material
- Modern Operating Systems
- NPTEL – Operating System Lectures
- MIT OpenCourseWare – Operating Systems Course